Closing the FY27 SASE gap with coverage, timing, and the SD-WAN bundle

To VP, SASE Go-to-Market
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Bottom line. FY27 needs $64.1M in SASE bookings, 35% above FY26's $47.5M. Current capacity reaches about 85% of that. Two win-rate plays close most of the gap at no headcount cost, and 4 specialist hires in uncovered mid-market territories close the rest. Q1 is ahead of pace; Q2 pipeline is the near-term risk.

What the data shows

- **The whitespace is concentrated and under-covered.** 3,141 firewall accounts do not own Prisma Access. Propensity-weighted whitespace is $91.1M, and half of it sits in 244 accounts. Territories without a SASE specialist attach at 12.1% against a modeled 28.6%: about 299 customers we would expect and do not have, concentrated in JAPAC and EMEA mid-market and commercial. This is a coverage problem, not a demand problem.
- **The SD-WAN bundle wins competitive deals.** Against Zscaler and Netskope, deals that include SD-WAN win 43% versus 22% without it, and the gap holds after controlling for coverage, segment, renewal timing, and source. Only 46% of those deals include SD-WAN today.
- **Timing matters.** Deals opened 90 to 270 days before the firewall renewal win 46% versus 35%. Only 28% of land deals are timed that way.
- **Q2 is the risk, not Q1.** Q1 is pacing 116% of plan, but pipeline closing in Q2 covers 0.64x of Q2's $16.7M plan.

Recommendations

- **Make SD-WAN the default in every Zscaler and Netskope deal.** Target a 75% bundle rate (from 46%). Owners: Product Marketing and Sales. Worth about 2.8 points of blended win rate.
- **Run a renewal-timed attach play.** Every account renewing its firewall in 90 to 270 days gets a SASE motion; target 50% of land deals (from 28%). Owners: GTM Strategy and Sales Ops. Worth about 2.3 points.
- **Approve 4 SASE specialists now for JAPAC and EMEA mid-market.** About $700K in FY27 cost for $9.1M of annual capacity once ramped. Hiring alone would take 14 specialists and $2.5M.
- **Start a Q2 pipeline sprint with Marketing and Partners.** Lift weekly pipeline creation from $2.0M to $3.0M through mid-November, prioritizing mid-market and commercial deals short enough to close inside Q2.

Expected impact

The two plays alone move modeled FY27 attainment from 85% to 95%. With 4 hires it reaches 100%, about $9.5M above the current path. On the Prisma Browser launch, POV starts are at 80% of plan and JAPAC certification is at 60%; I would add SE capacity for POVs before adding more top-of-funnel spend.

Risks and what would change my mind

- **Selection, not coverage.** Covered territories may have been chosen because they were stronger. The clean test is a pilot: add coverage to half of the eligible uncovered territories and compare attach after two quarters.
- **Comp and channel conflict.** Overlay specialists double-credit core sellers and can crowd partners; rules of engagement come before hiring.
- **Ramp and discounting.** If hiring lead time slips past five months, hires add little in FY27 and the plays carry more weight. Watch bundle discounting so win-rate gains do not come out of deal size.

Method: synthetic book of 4,200 firewall accounts and 3,096 validated opportunities (31 quarantined by automated checks); logistic look-alike model (cross-validated AUC 0.76) trained on specialist-covered territories; capacity model with ramp, attrition, and backfills. All data is synthetic and illustrative. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Palo Alto Networks.